

THE CRYPTO CONUNDRUM

FROM PAYMENT DISRUPTION TO THE CRYPTO BILL GETTING DELAYED, THERE ARE MANY CHALLENGES WHEN IT COMES TO INVESTING IN VIRTUAL CURRENCIES. IN THE ABSENCE OF FORMAL REGULATIONS AND GUIDELINES, HOW WISE IS IT TO BUY OR HOLD CRYPTOS IN INDIA?



BY **TEENA JAIN KAUSHAL**



ILLUSTRATION BY **NILANJAN DAS**



HAT DO YOU DO WHEN YOUR ENTIRE LIFE'S SAVINGS VANISHES IN A PUFF OF SMOKE? OR, WHEN YOU CAN NO LONGER ACCESS THE MONEY YOU HAVE PAINSTAKINGLY SAVED FOR A RAINY DAY?

NETFLIX'S LATEST DOCUMENTARY—TRUST NO ONE—THE HUNT FOR THE CRYPTO KING—ANSWERS PARTS OF THESE QUESTIONS AND SERVES AS A CAUTIONARY TALE FOR PEOPLE INVESTED IN THE CRYPTOCURRENCY MARKET. WATCHING THE DOCUMENTARY AND UNDERSTANDING ITS IMPLICATIONS CAN MAKE YOU GRASP YOUR BITCOIN A LITTLE CLOSER TO YOUR CHEST OR WITHDRAW FROM THE MARKET ENTIRELY.

THE TRUE CRIME DOCUMENTARY DEPICTS THE STORY OF A 30-YEAR-OLD CANADIAN, GERALD COTTEN,

CO-FOUNDER AND CEO OF QUADRIGACX—A CANADA-BASED CRYPTOCURRENCY EXCHANGE—WHO DIED UNDER MYSTERIOUS CIRCUMSTANCES IN JAIPUR.

COTTEN'S DEATH DUE TO COMPLICATIONS FROM CROHN'S DISEASE, WHILE LEAVING HIS CUSTOMERS IN A FINANCIAL LURCH, RAISED AS MANY QUESTIONS AS THE AMOUNT OF MONEY IT RENDERED INACCESSIBLE FOR HIS CUSTOMERS. INVESTIGATIONS INTO HIS DEATH CARRIED OUT BY FINANCIAL REGULATORS, JOURNALISTS AND QUADRIGACX'S CUSTOMERS IN CANADA AND THE US REVEALED MANY SORDID DETAILS. FOREMOST AMONG THEM WAS THE ALLEGATION THAT HE HAD BEEN DEFRAUDING HIS CUSTOMERS SINCE LONG BEFORE HIS DEATH IN DECEMBER 2018.